

Building the bower

The male Vogelkop bowerbird weaves twigs and plant stems around a sapling (young tree). When the bower is finished, it looks like a little thatched hut with an arched entrance.

Bowerbird

For male bowerbirds, finding a mate involves a lot of hard work. They collect brightly colored objects and display their “treasures” beside structures, called bowers, that are made from twigs. Each bowerbird species builds a different kind of bower, and the Vogelkop bowerbird makes the most spectacular of all.

Bowerbirds are found only in Australia and New Guinea.

Creating a lawn

The bird clears the ground in front of the entrance to the bower. He then covers this area with a layer of moss, until it looks like a lawn.

See also

Find out how the emperor penguin (108–109) and the wandering albatross (110–111) form longer partnerships to look after their young.

Aerial displays To court a female, a male peregrine falcon performs spectacular stunts in the air. This is to show her that he is a skilled enough flyer to catch food for her, and for her chicks when they hatch.



Colorful character Striking colors and spiral tail feathers help a male Wilson's bird of paradise attract a mate. He calls to females and fans out his bright green chest feathers to impress potential mates.

